

CUNY AI LAB

Configuring skills and tools

New Media Lab · Room 7388.01
CUNY Graduate Center

Thursday, October 15, 2026 · 2:30–4:00 p.m. Eastern

Developed by Zach Muhlbauer

https://cuny-ai-lab.github.io/sandbox-series/skills

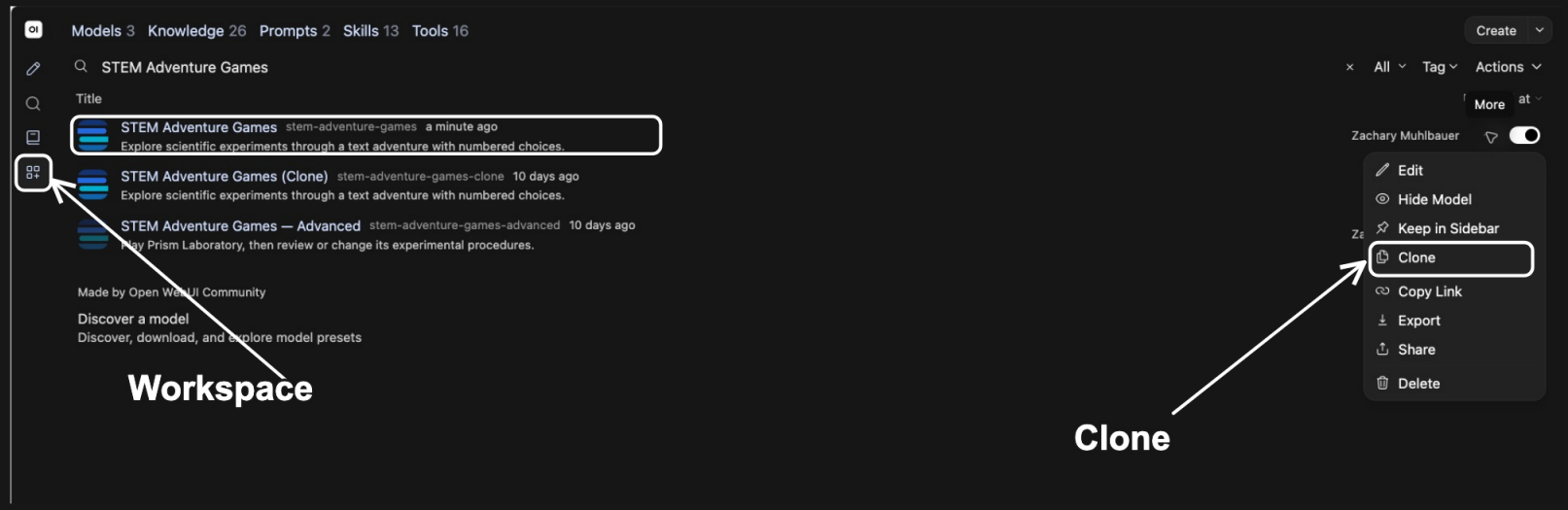
Choose Your Own Adventure

Continue your saved model or clone it first

Open **Workspace → Models → Edit**
Read your actual system prompt
Identify setting, goals, and rules

Keep this model card open while you add a skill and a tool

Select **Workspace** in left sidebar, then **Models**. Search for **STEM Adventure Games**. Open ••• beside it and select **Clone**.



What Is a Skill?

Skills contain plain-text instructions for repeatable tasks

Trigger	Request or condition that starts a procedure
Procedure	Steps, checks, and points that require a question
Output	Required response content and form

Skill Examples

Extend Adventure Games

Follow a saved adventure procedure

Call Adventure Kit as directed by the skill

Read the saved instructions in **Workspace → Skills**

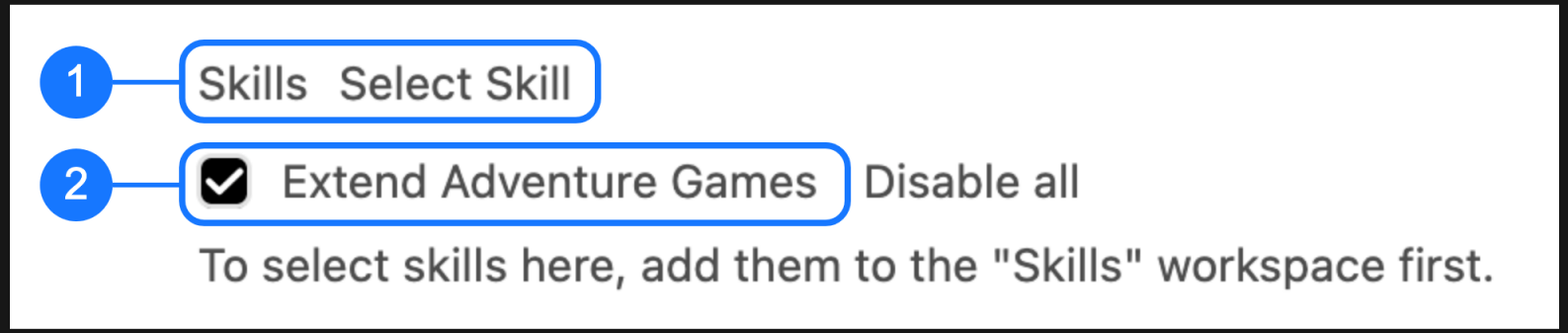
Add Your Skill

In **Workspace → Models → Edit**, find **Skills → Select Skill**

Choose existing **Extend Adventure Games**

Read its saved instructions

Keep this model card open for Adventure Kit



What Is a Tool?

When a model calls a **tool**, Sandbox executes a function and returns its result

Tool calling, otherwise known as **function calling**, sends a function name and arguments for execution

Input	Arguments supplied to a function
Execution	Code that applies specified rules
Result	Returned output for a model to inspect

Tool Examples

Workspace → Tools

Examples from the host's catalog. Your list depends on access

Adventure Kit v2.0.0 8 hours ago

Create participant-defined choice adventures with configurable state, rules and endings. No built-in scenario.

Chat Export v0.3.1 21 hours ago

Saves chat content (headings, text, lists and tables) as a downloadable Word (.docx) or PDF file, plus Markdow...

Instructional Toolset v0.6.0 3 days ago

Deterministically lists and loads curriculum units for instructional AI models.

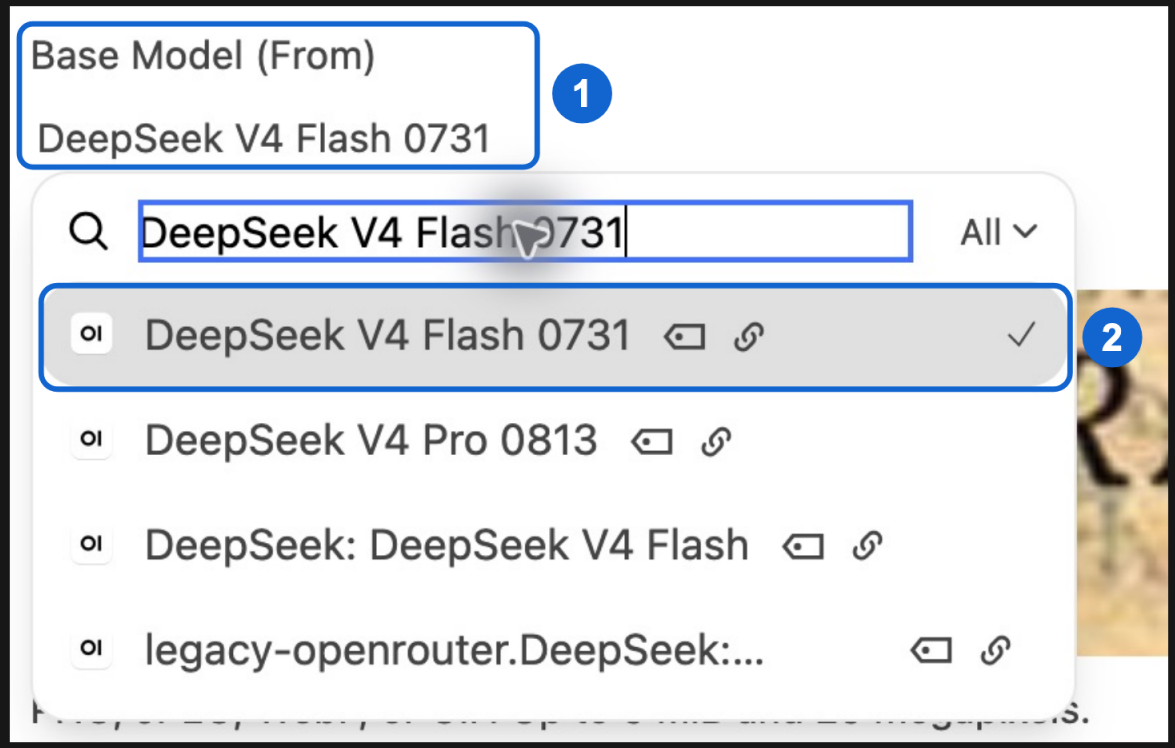
Pronunciation and Translation Tool ✨ v5.1.1 3 days ago

https://openwebui.com/posts/pronunciation_and_translation_tool_d8a83bca

ChartJS v2.0.0 2 months ago

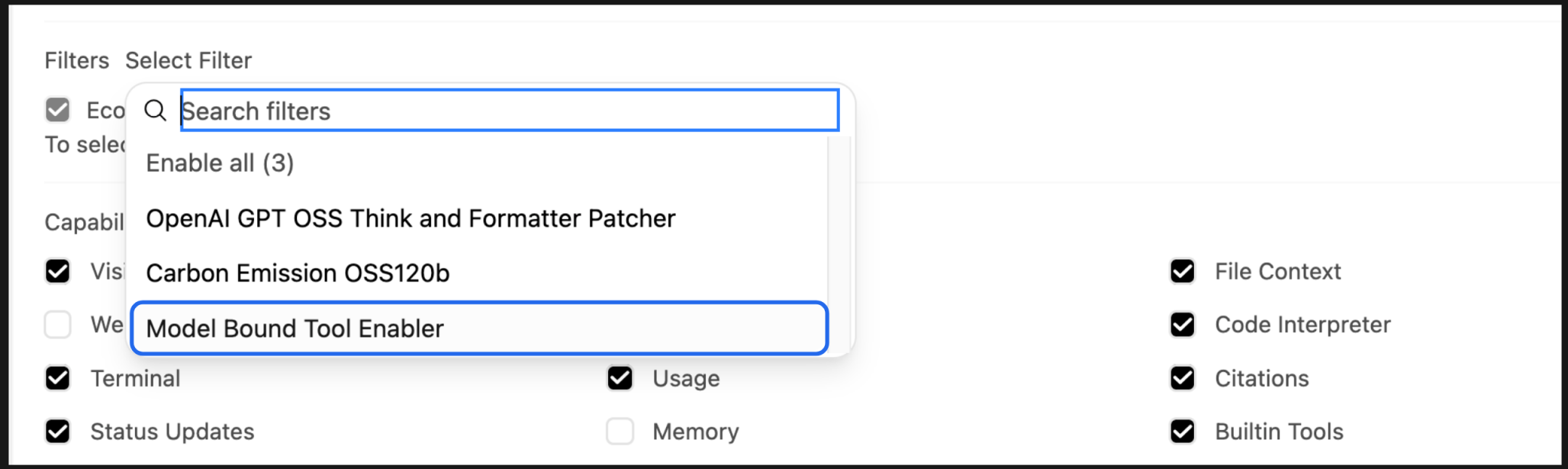
Charts is a tool for the Sandbox that renders chart elements in-chat using an HTML5 canvas via Chart.js cdn

Update Model for Tool Calling



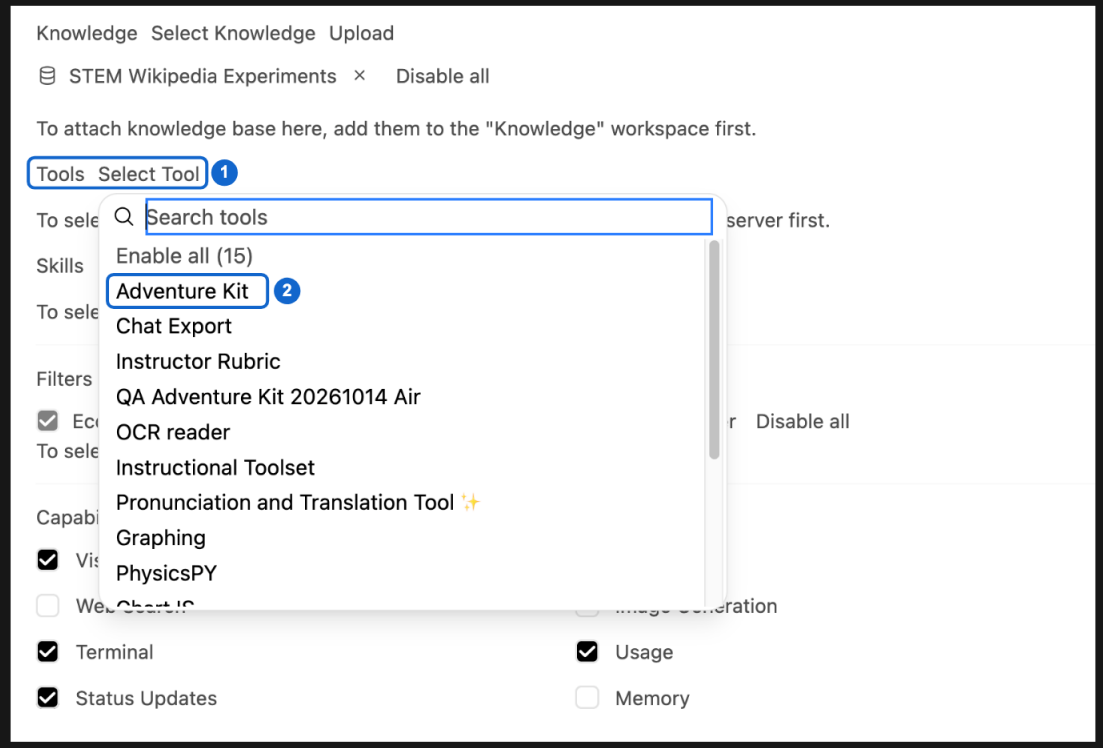
Enable Filter

Enable **Model Bound Tool Enabler** on your model card.
Why: It restores attached tools when a chat omits them.



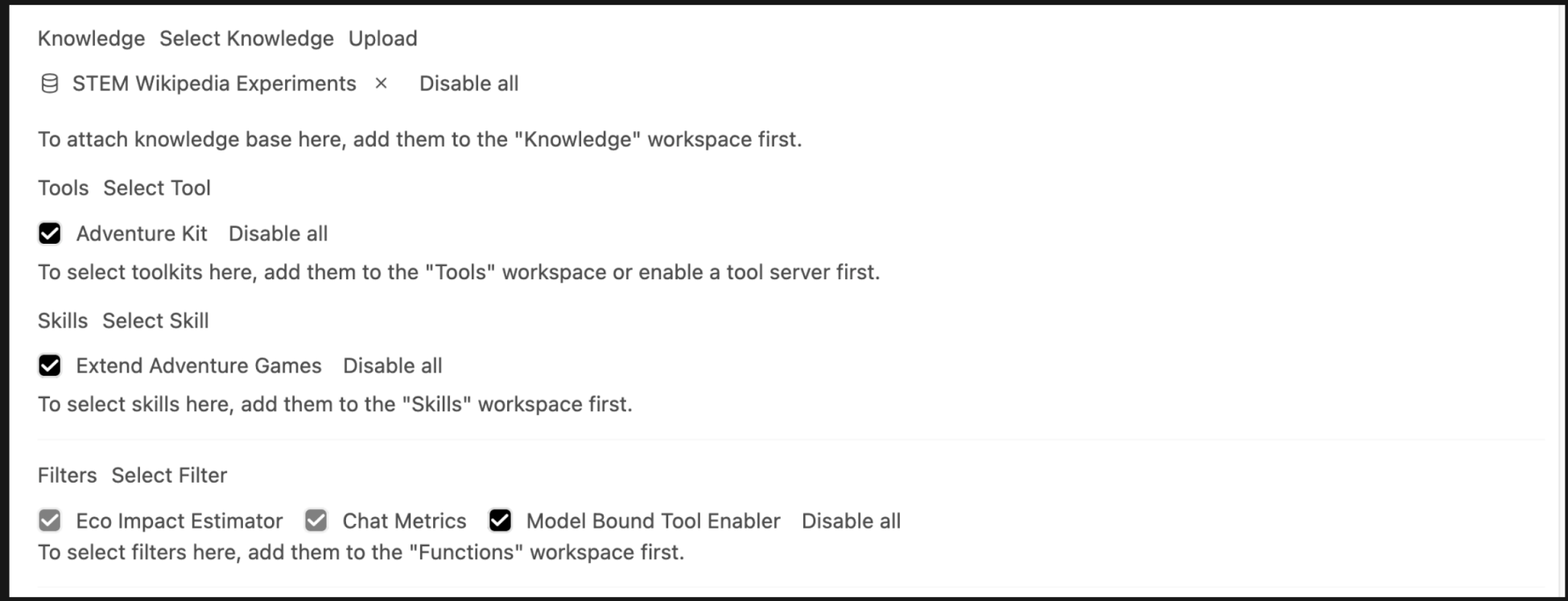
Add the ‘Adventure Kit’ tool

In this same model card, open **Tools → Select Tool**
Choose **Adventure Kit** · Confirm **Extend Adventure Games** remains selected
Add next prompt instruction, then click **Save & Update** before testing



Model Card Check-In

Ensure that your model card has a knowledge collection, tool, skill, and filter configured like the image below.



Add Skill Instructions to the Bottom of Your System Prompt

Copy prompt

```
Load the extend_adventure_games skill and follow it on every turn, calling the
adventure_kit tool only as the skill directs. Use no other skills or tools.
```

Test Your Adventure

Run your updated adventure game

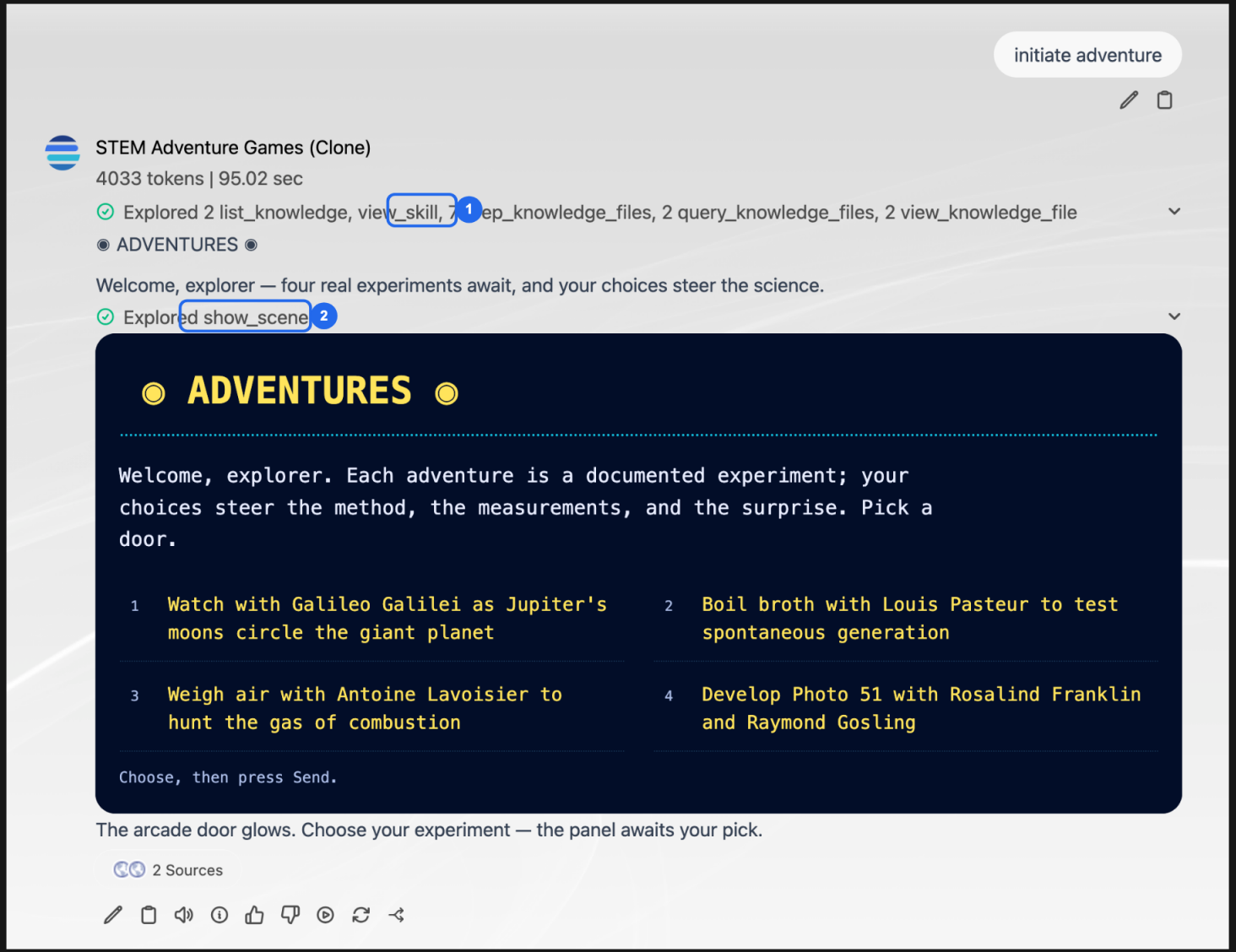
Verify configured skill and tool are called appropriately

Then play the rest of your game

Observe Game Results

① Check skill call
② Check tool call

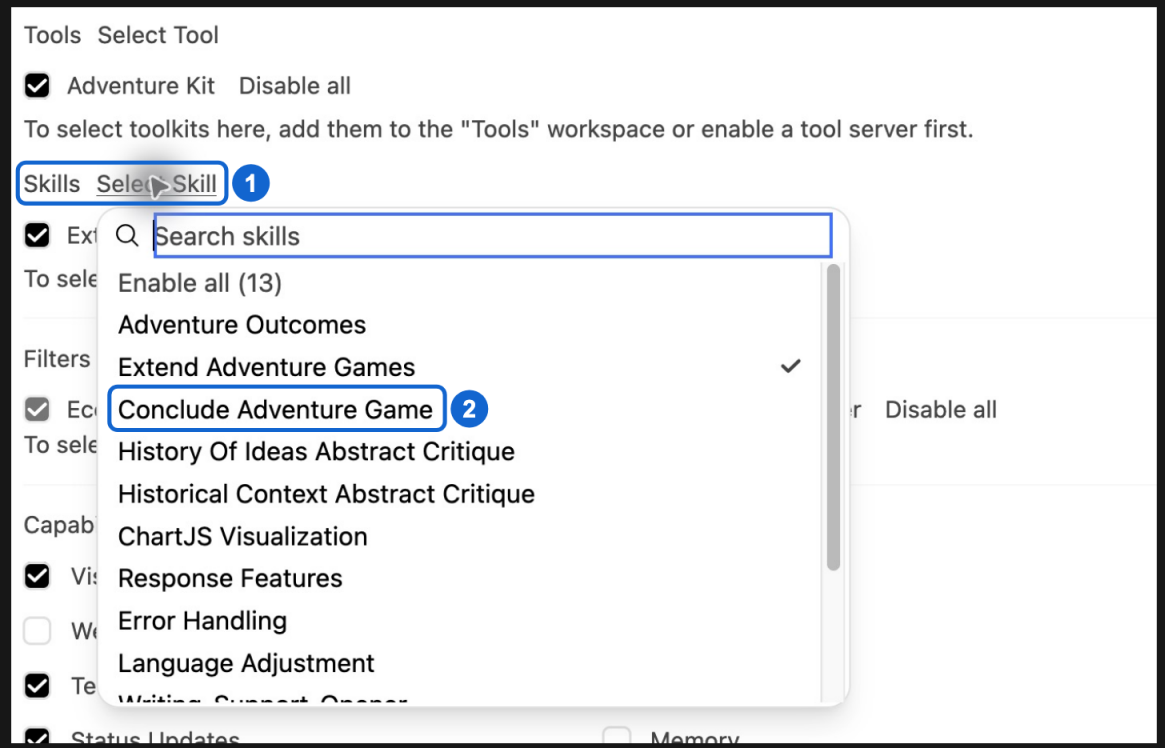
Open details to confirm selected skill



Explore Other Skills

After your first adventure works, try **Adventure Outcomes** or **Conclude Adventure Game** if available

Read saved instructions · Change one item · Save your model card and compare results



Choose Your Task

Revise One Item

Copy complete tool code or skill instructions

Describe an observed problem and one change

Copy tool code · Skill instructions

Create Your Own

Choose your own tool or skill

Specify purpose, required input, and expected result

Work With Support

Open **CAIL Workspace Support**
Paste original content or your new task, system prompt, and required sources
Request complete content, an explanation, and one test · Copy request



Adapt Your Adventure

Introduce a lesson plan, learning outcome, or disciplinary focus to your use of **CAIL Workspace Support** card

Prompted to generate a skill and/or tool that continues to support or further extends your adventure game, either adapting an existing skill or tool, or making your own.

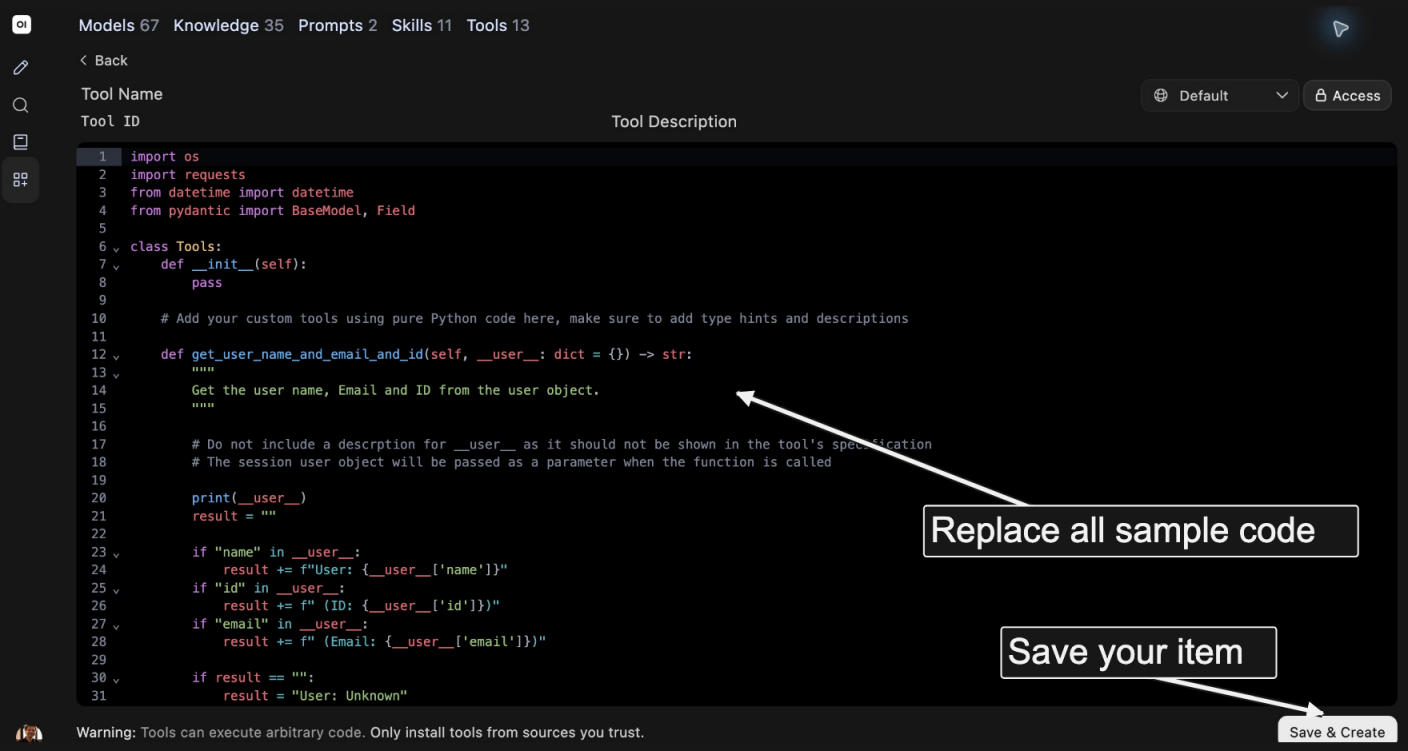
Add Tools or Skills

Create a new **tool** or **skill**, or save a revised copy

Use **Workspace → Tools → Create** or **Skills → Create**

Enter new Name and ID; paste complete reviewed content

Review **Access**, then **Save & Create** · Select and test your item



Series Reflections

What task in your teaching or research could benefit from a skill or tool?

Would you be interested in joining our coworking session on October 29, 2–4pm, to build your adventure into a collection so that we can showcase our work over the course of the series?

What would you develop next with the prompts, knowledge collections, skills, and tools you have explored?